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Toh 1980 · Derge Tengyur

This work, Toh 1980 in the Tengyur, is a short tantric ritual manual whose title does not appear in the opening lines provided, so its English, Sanskrit, and Tibetan names cannot be stated with confidence here. It opens with homage to Glorious Mañjuvajra, the form of Mañjuśrī at the centre of an important Guhyasamāja tradition, and it sets out a forceful rite to be performed only by a practitioner who has already attained great accomplishment, mastered meditative absorption, or perfected the mantra. The text specifies a suitable setting, such as a charnel ground, the foot of a solitary tree, or a crossroads where spirits dwell, and a time running from the twenty-second day of the lunar month until the new moon. It then describes how to satisfy the noble ones and the ḍākinīs with tormas and pure offerings, and how to win over the local seizing spirit with gifts and words of truth so that it becomes the practitioner's helper. As a practical manual of tantric ritual, it belongs among the commentarial and ritual treatises of the Tengyur's tantra section.

Homage to Glorious Mañjuvajra.

It is said: one who wishes to engage in this rite should be someone who has attained the great accomplishment of a major practice, or who is capable of any rite through meditative absorption, or who has perfected the mantra, and such a person should perform it.

As for the place: a charnel ground, the foot of a solitary tree, or a crossroads and the like, a place where spirits (bhūtas) dwell. As for the time: one should do it from the twenty-second day of the lunar month until the new moon.

First, one should satisfy the noble ones and the ḍākinīs with tormas (balis) and pure offerings. Then one should please the seizing spirit (graha) of that region with offerings and gifts, and, speaking words of truth, command it to be one's helper. One performs a pacifying fire offering (homa).

Then one should draw the wheel. Possessed of the meditative absorption of one's own deity, naked and facing south, one should draw it. In this way: take a cloth from a charnel ground and smear it with poison, blood, mustard seed, neem, the juice of datura, the leftovers of what crows have eaten, excrement, and great ash, and thoroughly cleanse the cloth. Make ink from the above

substances and from the charcoal of a corpse pyre, and draw the wheel with a crow's feather as the pen.

The wheel has three tiers. At the center draw eight yas. Then, from the second tier on, surround them with thirty-two syllables, and between one ya and the next write the name of the person to be targeted. On the last tier write the ten-syllable mantra with the name of the target interwoven. Outside that, draw a garland of syllables. In the directions and intermediate directions draw eight hūṃs. At the four corners draw phaṭ. While drawing, use the samaya mantra and the mudrā. When it is completed, bow to the deity and say, "May the command prove true."

Then take earth from an anthill, earth from between two riverbanks, the excrement of a king, and charcoal from a charnel ground. At midday or at midnight, knead them with urine, and make an effigy of the target, eight finger-widths tall. Roll up the wheel described above and insert it into the effigy's heart.

Then summon the target through the application of summoning, and bring him down upon the effigy. Drive human-bone daggers (kīlas) into the five places, and fill every joint with sharp thorns.

As for the summoning: abiding in the meditative absorption of the deity, visualize in front of you, upon a wind maṇḍala arisen from the syllable yaṃ, upon a moon seat, Yama, the Lord of Death, holding an iron hook and a noose. Urge him: "Summon the one named so-and-so! Come!" At the end of the mantra, recite: so-and-so, ākarṣaya hūṃ phaṭ. Then dissolve him into the effigy.

Then, at the time of driving in the daggers, visualize Yama holding various weapons, striking and devouring, and hosts of beasts of prey devouring and seizing the victim. At the end of the mantra recite: so-and-so, māraya phaṭ.

Then the liṅga should be placed inside a pair of joined skull cups. In this way: on the back of the lower skull cup draw a wind maṇḍala. Inside it, on a lotus of eight petals, write the heart mantra of casting down. Inside the upper skull cup draw a fire maṇḍala, and on its back draw the Mahendra maṇḍala together with Mount Meru. Place the liṅga inside, bind it with black thread, and set it on a black triangular maṇḍala. On leaves of the poison tree, roast it only until warm, and join it with the mantra.

On the first day, recite ten thousand times: oṃ yama rāja sadomeya, so-and-so, bhramaya kuru hūṃ phaṭ. In the same way, for four days, continue the mantra and the urging, and perform the recitation exactly as prescribed.

As for the visualization: by hosts of messengers the target is summoned and made to enter the amulet box (gau). There he is burned by the blaze of the mantra; his flesh and blood dry up, his consciousness departs, and one imagines his bones sitting there, pounded to ash.

At that time the practitioners should make torma offerings, assembly offerings, and worship at the three times of day, and should also urge Yama, who abides in his pledge, and the mātṛkās and ḍākinīs, entrusting them with the task.

Take earth from anthills in seven places. Make an image of Yama, the height of a man's forearm, with bared fangs, dark blue-black in color, holding a sword in his right hand, and with his left making the threatening gesture with a noose, naked, with loose hair, sitting. Place the amulet box at its heart. At midnight on the new moon, dig a deep pit in the fire pit of a charnel ground. Place the image there, invite Yama, and dissolve him into the image. Purify with tormas and offerings. Then turn its head to the south, lay it face down, call upon the truth as witness, entrust it to Yama, and leave it.

Then, having returned to one's own home, continue to urge it through the secret mantra.

This completes a section on the fierce rite of turning the wheel, from the Ritual Manual (Kalpa) of Glorious Vajrabhairava, composed by the master Śāntijñāna.

Translator's Notes

• The ritual wheel drawn here is a yantra with a spelled-out structure; I have kept the Tibetan's own counts (eight yas, thirty-two syllables, ten-syllable mantra). The Tibetan "che ge mo" is the placeholder for the target's name ("so-and-so"), and I have rendered it that way inside the mantras. The mantra transcribed as "bhramaya" reads "bha ma ya" in the Tibetan; the reading should be checked. The attribution to Śāntijñāna follows the colophon. The word "liṅga" is retained in Sanskrit; it denotes the effigy of the target. "Dbang chen" is taken as the Mahendra (earth) maṇḍala, which pairs with the wind and fire maṇḍalas on the skull cups. The homage is to Mañjuvajra; the colophon names the Vajrabhairava Kalpa as the source.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.